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SITREP

Intelligence Briefing

Europe/Africa

May 23, 2026

■ AI-GENERATED CONTENT

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (BLUF)

Ukraine's defensive capabilities are effectively stalling Russian advances, even as internal Kremlin dissent grows over the war's trajectory. Concurrently, Iran is solidifying its influence over the Strait of Hormuz, complicating U.S. and allied interests in the region amidst ongoing nuclear negotiations.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

- Ukraine continues to hold critical positions against Russian advances, with substantial daily casualties reported for Russian forces.
- Russia's nuclear exercises in Belarus showcase its reliance on strategic posturing to maintain influence amid battlefield difficulties.
- Iran's efforts to establish control over the Strait of Hormuz could escalate tensions with U.S. forces and regional allies.

RUSSIAN OFFENSIVE CAMPAIGN ASSESSMENT

Recent assessments indicate that Ukraine is successfully hindering Russian military operations, with significant territorial gains reported following Russia's loss of access to Starlink. Despite rising casualties, Russian President Vladimir Putin remains committed to military objectives in Donetsk and Luhansk, with Kremlin officials voicing concerns about the war's stagnation. The ongoing conflict has also led to increased military exercises, including nuclear drills in Belarus, which highlight Russia's strategic posturing amidst battlefield challenges.

Sources:

- Russian Offensive Campaign Assessment, May 22, 2026
- Russian Offensive Campaign Assessment, May 21, 2026
- Russian Offensive Campaign Assessment, May 20, 2026

IRAN'S CONTROL OVER THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ

Iran is actively working to normalize its control over the Strait of Hormuz, positioning itself as a security provider while compelling maritime vessels to comply with its demands. Ongoing

negotiations with the U.S. show slight progress, but major sticking points remain, particularly concerning Iran's enriched uranium and control of maritime transit. The potential for conflict is high, as Iran's actions could undermine international efforts to secure the Strait and destabilize the region further.

Sources:

- Iran Update Special Report, May 22, 2026
- Iran Update Special Report, May 21, 2026
- Iran Update Special Report, May 20, 2026

OUTLOOK

As Ukraine stabilizes its frontlines, Russia may resort to increased military exercises and rhetoric to assert pressure. Meanwhile, Iran's maneuvers in the Gulf suggest a long-term strategy to cement its influence, raising risks of confrontations with Western naval forces.